

## Geneva Declaration on the Future of the World Intellectual Property Organization

Humanity faces a global crisis in the governance of knowledge, technology and culture. The crisis is manifest in many ways.

- ✧ Without access to essential medicines, millions suffer and die;
- ✓ Morally repugnant inequality of access to education, knowledge and technology undermines development and social cohesion;
- ✚ Anticompetitive practices in the knowledge economy impose enormous costs on consumers and retard innovation;
- Authors, artists and inventors face mounting barriers to follow-on innovation;
- Concentrated ownership and control of knowledge, technology, biological resources and culture harm development, diversity and democratic institutions;
- ◆ Technological measures designed to enforce intellectual property rights in digital environments threaten core exceptions in copyright laws for disabled persons, libraries, educators, authors and consumers, and undermine privacy and freedom;
- ◆ Key mechanisms to compensate and support creative individuals and communities are unfair to both creative persons and consumers;
- ◆ Private interests misappropriate social and public goods, and lock up the public domain.

### Signing the Geneva Declaration on the Future of WIPO (*as of September 30, 2004*)

- ☀ 1Consumers International
- ☀ 1Medecins sans Frontieres, Access to Essential Medicines Campaign
- ☺ 2International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions (IFLA)
  - ✚ 3Martin Khor, Third World Network
  - ✚ 3Cory Doctorow, European Affairs Coordinator, Electronic Frontier Foundation
  - ✚ 3Sir John Sulston, Winner of 2002 Nobel Prize for Physiology or Medicine Former Director of the Wellcome Trust Sanger Institute, Cambridge, UK
  - ✚ 3Burton Richter, Paul Piggott Professor in the Physical Sciences, Stanford University, Nobel Laureate, Physics, 1976
- ☀ 1Paul A. David, Professor of Economics & Senior Fellow of the Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research, Stanford University, Senior Fellow of the Oxford Internet Institute & Professor Emeritus of Economics and Economic History, University of Oxford, Emeritus Fellow of All Souls College, Oxford
  - ✧ 2Philippe Aigrain, Founder and CEO, Society for Public Information Spaces
  - ✧ 2George Konrad, former President of International P.E.N.
  - ✧ 2Stéphane Hessel, Ambassador of France, Member, International Collegium
  - ✧ 2Lawrence Lessig, Professor of Law at Stanford Law School, Founder of the Stanford Center for Internet and Society, Chairman of the Creative Commons
- ☀ 1Jean Claude Guedon, Professor of Comparative Literature at the University of Montreal, Canada
  - ✧ 2Bernt Hugenholtz, Professor of Law, Institute for Information Law, University of Amsterdam
    - ✓ 3Jerome H. Reichman, Bunyan S. Womble Professor of Law, Duke University School of Law, Durham, NC USA
    - ✓ 3Yochai Benkler, Professor of Law, Yale Law School
    - ✓ 3William W. Fisher III, Professor, Harvard Law School
    - ✓ 3James Love, Consumer Project on Technology
- ☀ 1Rishab Aiyer Ghosh, MERIT, University of Maastricht, Netherlands.
  - ✧ 2Trans Atlantic Consumer Dialogue (TACD)
  - ✧ 2Celine Charveriat, Oxfam International
  - ✧ 2Alan Cox, Linux Project
    - ✓ 3Peter Drahos, Professor and Head of Program, Regulatory Institutions Network, Research School of Social Sciences, Canberra, Australia